



PHOTO BY VIDUSHI MEHROTRA

T

TECHNOLOGY HAS taken over the automobile industry. As cars shift from sedans to SUVs and from traditional engines to electric and hybrid options, cutting-edge tech is driving this change. It is no wonder, therefore, that the notion of connected cars has now become a hot topic, leading the way in this new era of smart driving. But what is a connected car? To begin with, connected cars are vehicles that come equipped with internet connectivity and various digital technologies that enable communication between the car, its internal systems, external devices, and cloud services. These vehicles can send and receive data, offering a wide range of features aimed at enhancing safety, convenience, efficiency, and entertainment for drivers and passengers.

So prevalent has this become now that according to a report by consulting firm McKinsey, by 2030, 95% of new vehicles sold globally will be connected. This is especially significant for domestic automobile manufacturers as they race to cater to consumer demand.

| 111

WHAT ARE CONNECTED CARS?

➔ **Connected cars or software-defined vehicles have internet access, enabling them to exchange data with both internal and external devices**

➔ **This is typically provided through mobile data networks, allowing various services to be remotely managed via smartphones or other devices**

➔ **As per Jato Dynamics, some of the top features in software-defined vehicles are remote services, remote battery management, remote HVAC and remote start**